

# Employment Coaching and Recruitment Workshop



## Session Learning Objectives

**By the end of this session, participants will learn how to:**

- 1 Present a clear professional introduction aligned to a target opportunity.
- 2 Defend CV evidence and respond to recruiter follow-up questions.
- 3 Demonstrate competency-based interview responses under realistic time constraints.
- 4 Evaluate recruitment performance using structured peer, coach, and AI-assisted feedback.
- 5 Prioritize immediate application, profile, and interview actions.

## Topics Covered

- 1 Briefing: standards, confidentiality, rotation, feedback rules
- 2 Grouping, rotating roles, and station rotation
- 3 Target opportunity and baseline self-rating
- 4 60-second introduction sprint
- 5 Station 1: CV defense
- 6 Station 2: Recruiter screen
- 7 Station 3: Job-fit analysis
- 8 Station 4: Competency interview
- 9 Station 5: Difficult interview moments
- 10 Feedback triangulation and priority themes
- 11 Individual action plan and milestone commitment
- 12 AI Activity 1: AI Pitch Coach
- 13 AI Activity 2: CV Evidence Stress-Test
- 14 AI Activity 3: Job-Fit Mapper
- 15 AI Activity 4: AI Interview Simulator
- 16 AI Activity 5: Feedback Synthesizer

# Briefing: Standards, Confidentiality, Rotation, Feedback

## Standards

Every station is scored on a written 1 to 5 scale. No score is given without a reason and one concrete example taken from what was actually said.



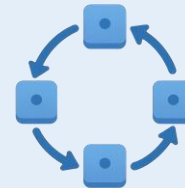
## Confidentiality

What is said in a station stays in the station. CVs and opportunity descriptions are not photographed, copied or shared outside the group.



## Rotation

Groups move on the coach signal, not on completion. An unfinished answer is data, not a failure, and it is scored as it stands.



## Feedback

One strength, one specific change, one next action. No general praise, no comments about personality, no advice without an example.



# Grouping, Rotating Roles, and Station Rotation

## 1 Candidate

Performs the station task under the real time limit.

## 2 Recruiter / Coach

Asks the station questions and pushes for two follow-ups.

## 3 Observer and Scorer

Completes the scorecard and records one verbatim quote.

## 4 Timekeeper

Runs the visible timer and enforces the AI time box.



# Target and Baseline Card

## PART A: DECLARE THE TARGET

### 1 Target role

A job title a recruiter would recognise, not a description of an interest.

### 2 Target employer type

Agency, product company, public sector, freelance client, or startup.

### 3 One real opportunity

A link, a posting reference, or a named employer you will apply to this month.

## PART B: RATE YOURSELF 1 TO 5

Professional introduction ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Defending CV evidence ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Competency answers under time ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Using feedback objectively ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Prioritizing next actions ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐



The baseline card stays face up on the table for the whole session. It is the only sheet measured twice.

# 60-Second Introduction Sprint

## STATION RUN SHEET

- 3 min** Write or recall your current professional introduction.
- 4 min** Deliver it to your pair partner. Partner scores and gives one strength and one change.
- 3 min** Run AI Activity 1, the AI Pitch Coach, on the weakest segment.
- 4 min** Deliver the revised version. Partner rescores against the same five criteria.
- 1 min** Record both scores on the baseline card.

**Everybody delivers twice. A single delivery does not complete the block.**



# Anatomy of a 60-Second Introduction

| 0-10 s                  | 10-25 s                                                                                   | 25-40 s | 40-50 s | 50-60 s |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------|---------|
| 1 Who you are           | Name, professional identity in one phrase, one anchor: employer, field, or qualification. |         |         |         |
| 2 What you do and proof | The work itself plus exactly one measurable result. One is enough; more is worse.         |         |         |         |
| 3 Value you create      | The problem you remove for the employer or client. The segment most often missing.        |         |         |         |
| 4 Why this opportunity  | The specific link between you and this target. If it fits any employer, it does nothing.  |         |         |         |
| 5 The ask               | The next step you want, stated plainly: a call, a technical conversation, a review.       |         |         |         |

# Pitch Scorecard

| Criterion                                                                           | 1                     | 2                     | 3                     | 5                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1 <b>Clarity</b> Could a stranger repeat what you do after hearing it once?         | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| 2 <b>Relevance</b> Is the content aimed at this target opportunity: or at everyone? | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| 3 <b>Evidence</b> Is there at least one specific, verifiable result?                | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| 4 <b>Delivery</b> Pace, pauses; eye contact; and no filler opening.                 | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| 5 <b>Close</b> Is there a clear, reasonable ask at the end?                         | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

**1 Absent**  
The criterion did not appear at all.

**3 Generic**  
It appeared, but it would fit any candidate for any role.

**5 Convincing**  
It appeared with a detail only this candidate could give.

# AI Activity 1: AI Pitch Coach

## 1 Feed the model your facts

Paste your current introduction, your target role, and the opportunity description. Add the three results you are proudest of. Facts only, no-adjectives.

## 2 Ask for a diagnosis, not a rewrite

Ask which segment of the sixty seconds is weakest and why, scored against the five scorecard criteria, quoting your own words.

## 3 Request three variants

Ask for three sixty-second versions at different emphases: results-led, problem-led, and targeted. Choose one, don't merge all three.

## 4 Humanize and cut

Read your chosen version aloud with a timer. Delete any sentence you would not say to a person sitting opposite you.

### WHAT YOU NEED ON THE TABLE

- Your current 60-second introduction
- The opportunity description
- Three results with numbers
- A visible timer

### WHAT GOES WRONG

Asking for a rewrite first. You get a fluent paragraph you cannot defend under a follow-up question, and you lose the second delivery.

## AI Activity 1: The Prompt

*Copy it exactly. Change only the bracketed parts.*

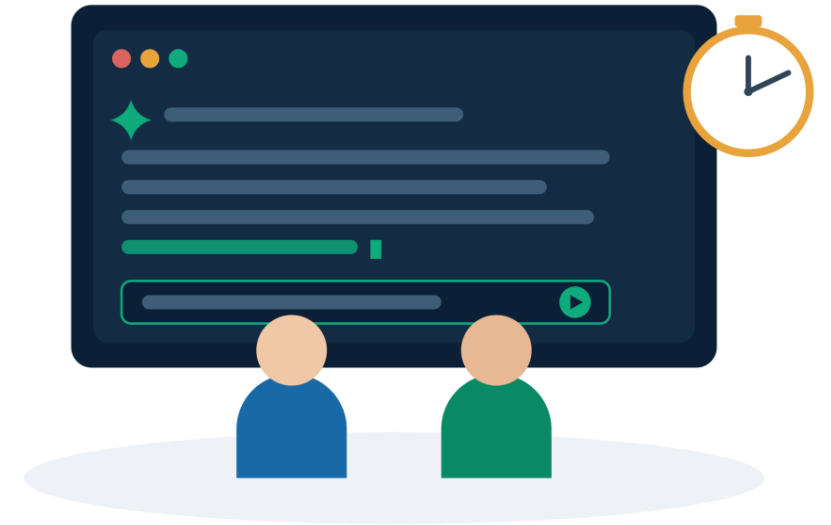
### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

*Act as a recruitment coach. Here is my 60-second professional introduction: [paste it]. Here is the opportunity I am targeting: [paste the description].*

*Score my introduction from 1 to 5 on clarity, relevance to this opportunity, evidence, delivery, and closing ask. For each score, quote the exact words of mine that caused it.*

*Then write three revised 60-second versions: one results-led, one problem-led, one target-led. Keep every factual claim exactly as I stated it, invent nothing, and mark any place where you think I am missing evidence.*

*Output the scores as a table and the three versions as plain text with a word count for each.*



# AI Activity 1: Reading and Iterating

*Three checks on what comes back, then three follow-up lines.*

1

## Check the quotes first

If the model cannot quote your phrase, the score is guesswork. Ignore it.

2

## Read the evidence gaps

Those markers are your homework. They carry into the action plan at minute 170.

3

## Check the word count

About 130 to 150 words is sixty spoken seconds. Over 170 will overrun.

## THEN ITERATE WITH

*"Version 2 is closer. Rewrite it using only the vocabulary in the opportunity description."*

*"Cut it to 120 words without removing the result."*

*"Now give me the three follow-up questions a recruiter would ask after this."*

# Station 1: CV Defense

## STATION RUN SHEET

5 min

Candidate presents the three CV lines most relevant to the target opportunity.

12 min

Coach interrogates each line against the evidence test, two follow-ups minimum.

5 min

Run AI Activity 2, the CV Evidence Stress-Test, on the weakest line.

3 min

Rewrite the weakest line on the CV itself and delete one line.

Coaches interrogate. Encouragement belongs in the feedback minute, not the defense.

Defensiveness is the moment worth coaching. It is scored under Recovery.



### THE THREE-LINE RULE

Three lines only, chosen for this opportunity.  
Whole-CV reviews produce Formatting comments, which are worthless here.



### MUST EXIST BY MINUTE 90

- Three rewritten evidence lines
- One line deleted
- One named gap to close

# The Evidence Test: Relevant, Specific, Credible

*Every line on a CV must survive all three questions, not two of them.*

## Relevant

- 1 Does this line move the reader toward a requirement written in the opportunity description, or is it just history?

## Specific

- 2 Is there a number, a scope, a timeframe, or a named tool? "Improved performance" carries no information.

## Credible

- 3 Could a recruiter check it, through a person, a link, a repository, a certificate, or a published result?



## WEAK

*"Responsible for social media accounts and improving engagement."*

## STRONG

*"Managed 4 client accounts; raised average engagement from 1.8% to 4.1% over 6 months; reported monthly in Meta Business Suite."*

# Coach Question Bank: CV Defense

*Ask questions 2 and 5 on every line. They expose most weak evidence in under a minute.*

1 Which requirement in the opportunity description does this line answer?

3 What was the number before you started, and after?

5 Who can confirm this, and how would they confirm it?

7 What went wrong in this project, and what did you change?

2 What exactly did you do, and what did the team do?

4 Over what period, and at what scale?

6 What would I see if I opened the file, repository or account today?

8 If I removed this line, what would I lose about you?

# CV Defense Scorecard

Five criteria. A score of 4 or 5 must be justified by something the observer can point at.

|   |                                                                                                     | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | <b>Targeting</b><br>The CV is visibly aimed at this opportunity, not at a category of jobs.         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 2 | <b>Evidence density</b><br>Results carry a number, a scope, a timeframe, or a named tool.           | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 3 | <b>Verifiability</b><br>The claims are ones a recruiter could actually check.                       | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 4 | <b>Ownership</b><br>The candidate separates personal contribution from team output.                 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 5 | <b>Recovery</b><br>The candidate handles a challenge to a claim without defensiveness or invention. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Record one verbatim quote next to the lowest score.

## THE POINTING RULE

A 4 or 5 on Evidence density requires the observer to point at a number, a scope or a named system inside the line itself. If they cannot point at it, the maximum is 3.

## WHAT SCORES HIGH ON RECOVERY

*"I do not have that number with me. I can get it from the monthly report and send it by Sunday."*

## AI Activity 2: CV Evidence Stress-Test

### 1 Isolate one line

Do not paste the whole CV. Take the single weakest evidence line your coach identified. One line protects your data and produces sharper questions.

### 2 Ask the model to attack it

Ask for the questions a skeptical recruiter would ask, ranked by how damaging they are. Instruct it explicitly not to rewrite anything yet.

### 3 Answer the attack in writing

Write your real answers on paper. Where you have no answer, write GAP. Those gaps become action items at minute 170.

### 4 Rebuild the line

Ask it to rewrite the line using only the facts in your answers, with no added adjectives, then cut it to one line.



**One line in. Never the whole CV.**

## AI Activity 2: The Two Prompts

*Sent in sequence, with your own written answers in between.*

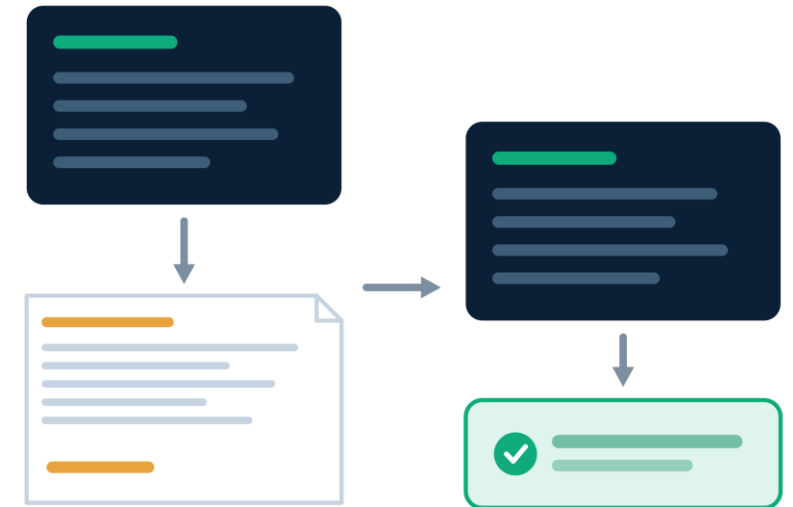
### PROMPT A: THE ATTACK

*You are a skeptical technical recruiter. This single line is from my CV: [paste one line]. This is the opportunity I am applying to: [paste]. List the five questions you would ask to test whether this line is relevant, specific and credible, ordered from most to least damaging. Do not rewrite anything yet. Wait for my answers.*

**Now write your real answers by hand. Where you have no answer, write GAP.**

### PROMPT B: THE REBUILD

*Here are my answers: [paste]. Now rewrite the line using only facts contained in my answers. Do not add adjectives and do not add achievements I did not state. Give me one version of 25 words or fewer and one of 40 words or fewer, and list any claim you had to drop for lack of evidence.*



## AI Activity 2: Reading the Output

1

### The dropped-claims list

The most valuable output of the activity. It names the parts of your CV that are currently unsupportable, which is exactly what a recruiter finds and never tells you.

2

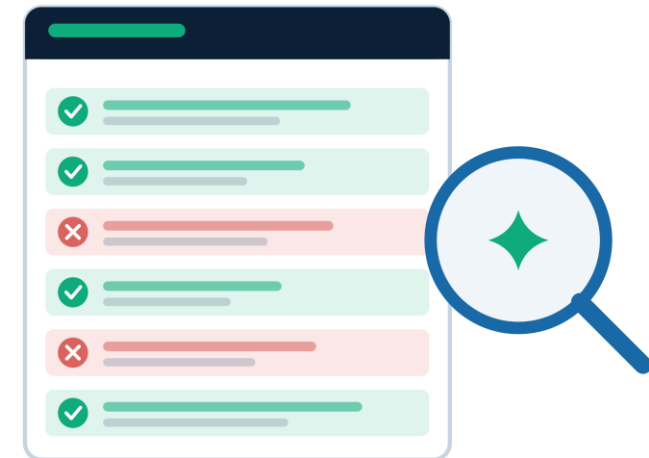
### Invented numbers

Any figure you did not supply means the sentence is fiction. Delete it and run prompt B again.

3

### Vocabulary drift

Models substitute synonyms. If the employer wrote one term and the rewrite uses another, the screening system may not match it.



What leaves this station: one rewritten line on the CV itself, and one line deleted.

## Station 2: Recruiter Screen

### STATION RUN SHEET

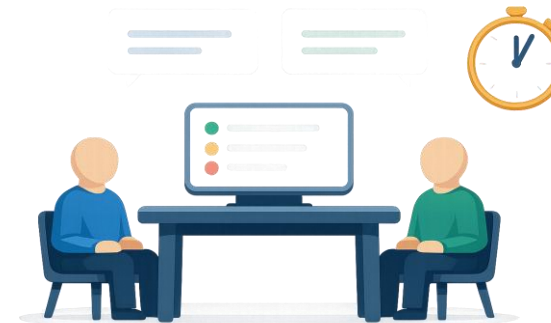
**5 min** The screen itself, strictly timed. The recruiter stops on the clock.

**5 min** The recruiter states the decision and the single sentence that decided it.

**5 min** Rerun only the two weakest minutes of the conversation.

**5 min** Scoring, plus one verbatim quote for the lowest item.

**5 min** Role swap and reset for the next candidate.



### THE CLOCK IS THE POINT

Five minutes, visible timer, stopped mid-sentence if needed. Real screens end on the clock.

### RECRUITER MUST SAY OUT LOUD

*"My decision is [advance / hold / reject], because [one sentence]."*

### WHY THE RERUN MATTERS

Most candidates improve sharply on the second attempt. That proves the problem is preparation, not personality.

# What the Five-Minute Screen Really Tests

## 1 One-sentence identity

Can the recruiter repeat what you do after the call? If not, nothing else in the conversation matters.

## 2 Realistic expectations

Role level, salary band, notice period, location, work model. Avoiding the salary question wastes everyone's time.

## 3 Workable logistics

Start date, notice period, travel or visa constraints, and availability for the next interviews.

## 4 A reason for this employer

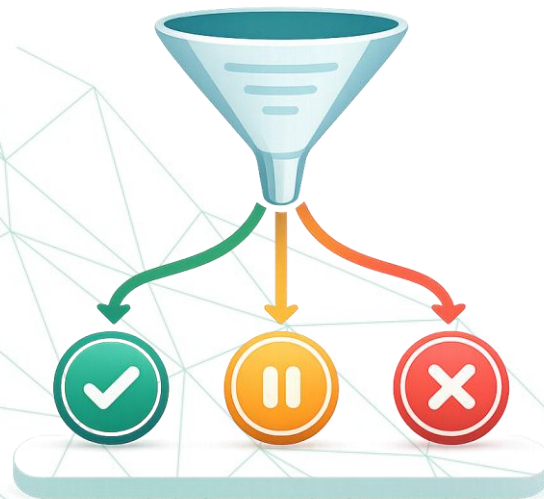
A visible, specific reason you applied here. Generic enthusiasm reads as a negative signal.

## 5 Ease under mild pressure

Recruiters are testing what a hiring manager will experience for forty-five minutes.

# The Next-Step Decision: Advance, Hold, Reject

*The recruiter states the decision word, then the one sentence that decided it.*



Teach candidates to ask: what would move this from hold to advance?

## ADVANCE

The recruiter would book the next conversation today.

- Clear one-sentence identity
- At least one relevant evidence point
- Realistic expectations
- No logistics blocker

## HOLD

The substance is there but one thing is unresolved.

- Notice period unclear
- Salary gap to close
- Seniority not yet established
- Portfolio or evidence missing

## REJECT

A mismatch that no further conversation fixes today.

- Wrong role level or domain
- Expectations far outside the band
- No relevant evidence at all
- Unreliable communication

# Screening Scorecard

|          |                                     | 1                                                                               | 2                     | 3                     | 4                     | 5                     |                       |
|----------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>One-sentence identity</b>        | The recruiter could repeat what the candidate does, accurately, after the call. | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Relevance to the opportunity</b> | The content was aimed at this posting, using the employer's own vocabulary.     | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Expectation realism</b>          | Level, salary band, notice and logistics were stated clearly and workably.      | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>Question quality</b>             | What the candidate asked about the role and the team, not about benefits.       | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Conversational control</b>       | Answers landed inside sixty to ninety seconds and left the recruiter steering.  | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

## RECORDING RULE

Write the words, not your interpretation of the words. At minute 155 a quote is usable evidence; an interpretation is an opinion.

## QUESTIONS THAT SCORE WELL

*"What does success look like in the first ninety days?"*

*"Who would I work with most closely?"*

*"What is the biggest constraint the team faces now?"*

## Station 3: Job-Fit Analysis

### STATION RUN SHEET

4 min

- Extract every requirement from the posting, in the employer's own words.

5 min

- Attach one piece of evidence from your CV to each requirement.

3 min

- Mark every requirement with no evidence as a gap.

3 min

- Convert each gap into one action with a deadline.



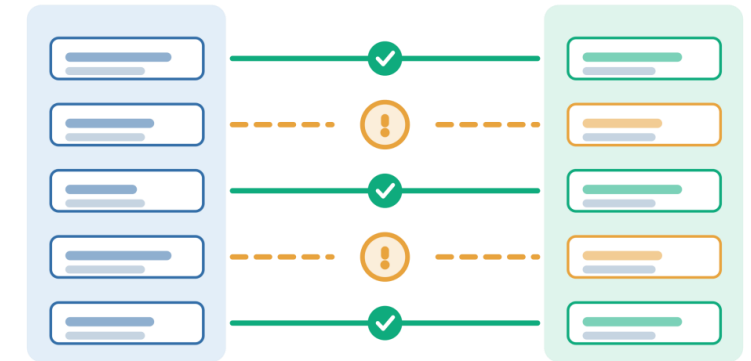
A map where every requirement is evidenced means the posting was not read carefully.



## Building the Fit Map

*Four columns. Requirement in the employer's words, then evidence, gap, and a 30-day action.*

| Requirement<br>(employer's words)                | Evidence you already have                    | Gap            | Action within 30 days                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three years commercial experience with REST APIs | Two years, four shipped integrations         | One year short | Foreground the four integrations; add scope and traffic numbers |
| Client-facing communication                      | Weekly client reporting across four accounts | None           | Move this line to the top third of the CV                       |
| Team leadership                                  | None recorded                                | Full gap       | Lead the next two-person task and document the outcome          |



**A gap you cannot close in thirty days is not a gap. It is a targeting decision.**

## AI Activity 3: Job-Fit Mapper

- 1



**Give the model both documents**

The opportunity description and your CV, as plain text.  
Strip your phone number and address first.
- 2



**Ask for extraction before judgement**

List the requirements exactly as written, before comparing anything.  
Otherwise it summarises the posting.
- 3



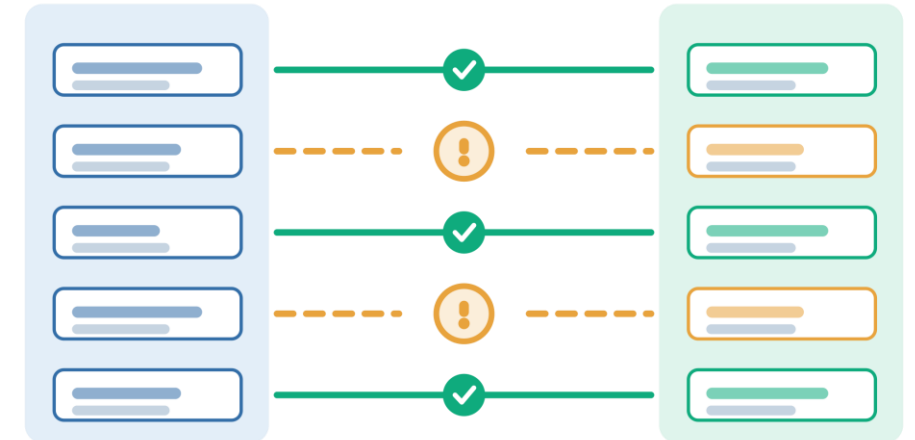
**Ask for a three-way classification**

Evidenced, partially evidenced, or not evidenced.  
Partial is where most candidates live.
- 4



**Convert gaps into checkable actions**

One 30-day action per gap, each producing something a recruiter could open.



**Mechanical work. Give it to the model.**

## AI Activity 3: The Prompt

*Three numbered steps in one message. The column order matches your fit map sheet.*

### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

*Here is an opportunity description: [paste]. Here is my CV: [paste].*

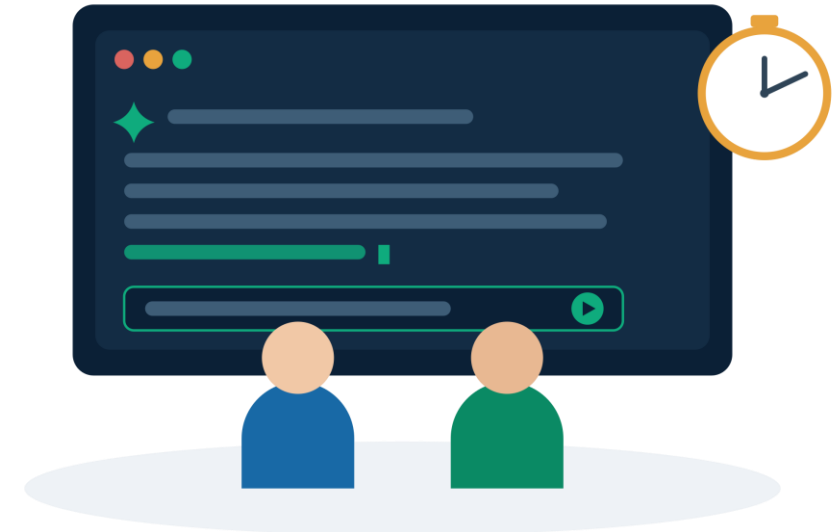
*Step 1: extract every stated requirement as a numbered list, using the employer's own wording. Do not merge requirements and do not add any.*

*Step 2: for each requirement, classify my CV as evidenced, partially evidenced, or not evidenced, and quote the exact CV text you used. If you find no supporting text, say not evidenced.*

*Step 3: for every requirement that is not fully evidenced, propose one action I can complete within 30 days that produces something a recruiter can check.*

*Output one table with four columns: requirement, classification, CV quote, 30-day action.*

**Keep the column order. It matches the sheet on your table.**



## AI Activity 3: Verifying the Output

1

### Merged or invented requirements

Compare the model's list against the posting, line by line. Models merge, and occasionally add one that was never there.

2

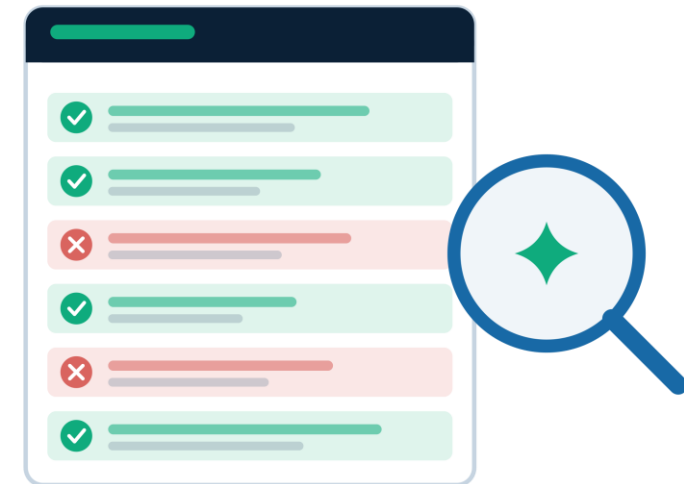
### Quotes that are not in your CV

The most common failure of the session. The fabricated quote usually sounds exactly like something you would have written.

3

### Actions producing nothing checkable

Replace them yourself. A second prompt will only return another vague verb.



### GOOD ACTION VERSUS BAD ACTION

*Bad: "Learn more about container orchestration."*

*Good: "Deploy the project to a two-node cluster and link the repository by 20 August."*



**15 MINUTES**

## Station 4: Competency Interview

### STATION RUN SHEET

|        |                                                                                                   |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4 min  | Interviewer selects three competencies from the candidate's fit map and drafts one question each. |
| 12 min | The interview: four minutes per competency, including follow-ups.                                 |
| 6 min  | Run AI Activity 4 on the weakest competency only.                                                 |
| 5 min  | Scoring, with one verbatim quote per competency.                                                  |
| 3 min  | Role swap and reset.                                                                              |

Scoring needs the exact sentence, not a summary of it.

### THE NON-NEGOTIABLE RULE OF THIS STATION

Two follow-ups per competency, minimum. One question and a move on produces a pleasant conversation with no assessment value. This is the one place coaches should interrupt.

### USE THE FIT MAP

The three competencies come from the fit map built at Station 3. Choosing at random wastes that work and disconnects the session.

### TIME BUDGET

Four minutes per competency, including both follow-ups. It is deliberately tight, because real competency interviews are.

# STAR Under Time Pressure

*Everyone knows the acronym. Almost nobody allocates the seconds correctly.*



## Situation

15 sec

Where, when, and the scale. Nothing else. No org chart and no history.

## Task

15 sec

What you specifically owned, separated from what the team owned.

## Action

60 sec

Half the answer. The decisions you made, in sequence, in the first person singular.

## Result

30 sec

The outcome with a number, plus one sentence on what you would repeat or change.

**Two minutes total. Action is half of it.**

## THE CLASSIC FAILURE

Ninety seconds of Situation and ten seconds of Result. Cut the candidate at twenty-five seconds if Situation is still running.

## IF ACTION WILL NOT FILL

The example is too small. Choose a different one rather than padding the Situation.

# Follow-Up Probing: How Coaches Dig

*Four levels, used in order. Reach level 2 on every competency and level 3 on at least one.*

## 1 Specify

*"What exactly did you do in that step?"*

Used when the candidate speaks in the plural or in the abstract.

## 2 Quantify

*"How many, how long, what changed?"*

Where most weak answers stop being convincing.

## 3 Challenge

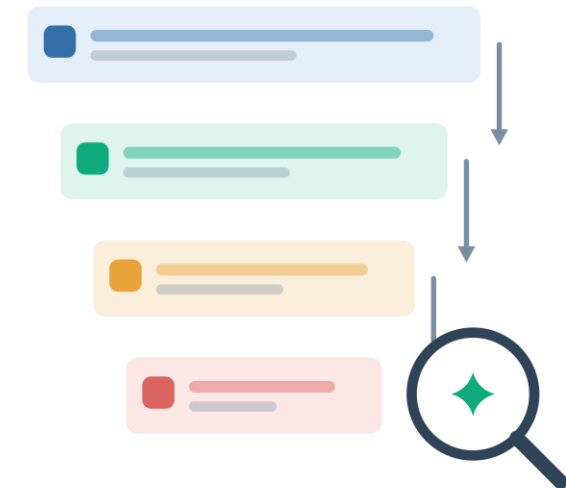
*"What would have happened if you had not done that?"*

Tests whether the action mattered or was incidental.

## 4 Transfer

*"Where would that approach fail, and what would you do instead?"*

The senior-level probe. It separates understanding from rehearsal.

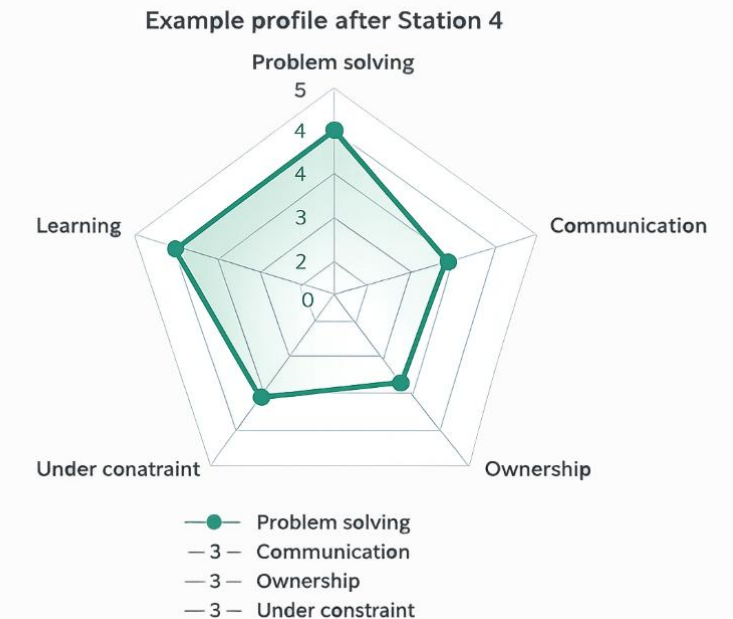


One probe at a time. Stacking two lets the candidate answer the easier one.

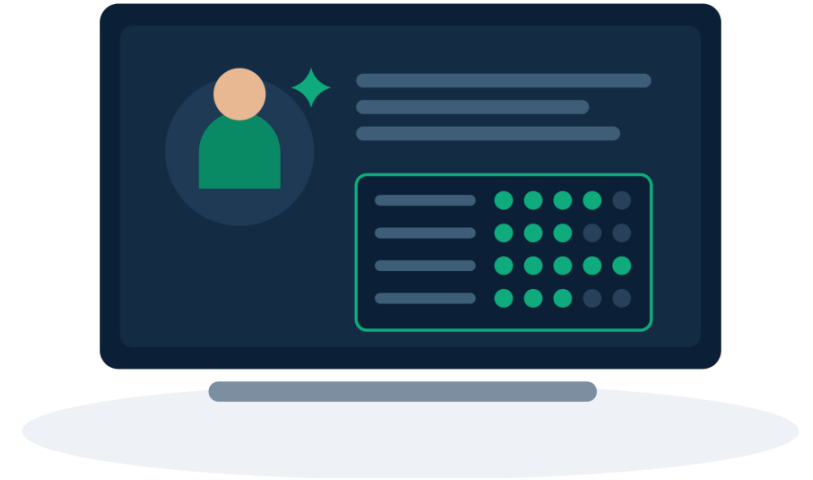
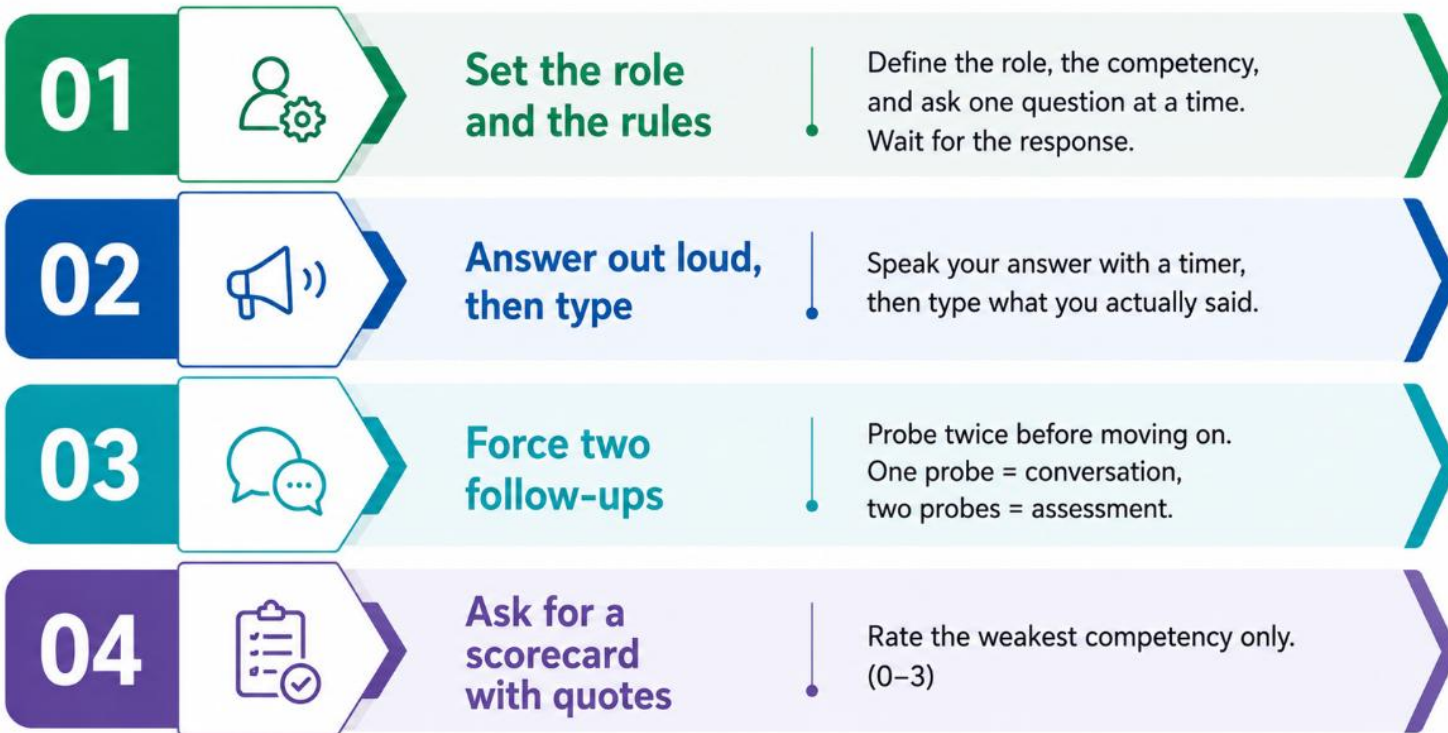
# Competency Interview Scorecard

Choose three competencies. A score of 4 or 5 requires a quoted example with a number or a named outcome.

|                                                                                     |                                                  |                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01                                                                                  | <b>Problem solving</b>                           | Diagnoses before acting;<br>chooses between options with a stated reason.       |
| 02                                                                                  | <b>Client and stakeholder communication</b>      | Explains technical work to a<br>non-technical listener without losing accuracy. |
| 03                                                                                  | <b>Ownership and accountability</b>              | Separates personal contribution from team output<br>and names their own errors. |
| 04                                                                                  | <b>Working under constraint</b>                  | Delivers when time, budget,<br>information or headcount is short.               |
| 05                                                                                  | <b>Learning and adaptation</b>                   | Acquires what the work needs<br>and shows the evidence of having done it.       |
|  | No quote, no 4 or 5. The <b>score caps at 3.</b> |                                                                                 |



## AI Activity 4: AI Interview Simulator



The two rewritten sentences are a direction, not a script.

## AI Activity 4: The Prompt

*Every constraint prevents a specific failure. Do not remove any of them.*

### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

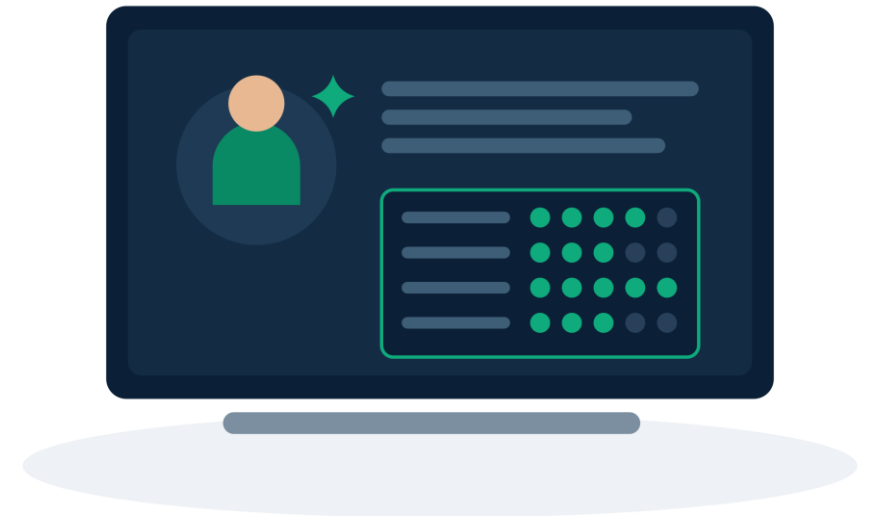
*You are interviewing me for this opportunity: [paste]. Run a competency-based interview on [competency name] only.*

*Ask one question at a time and wait for my answer. After each answer, ask exactly two follow-up questions that probe for specifics and numbers. Do not give feedback during the interview.*

*After three exchanges, stop and produce a scorecard from 1 to 5 for structure, specificity, ownership and result, quoting my exact words for each score.*

*Then list the two weakest sentences I said, with a rewritten version of each that uses only facts I already gave you.*

**One competency only. Six minutes does not cover three.**



## AI Activity 4: Reading the Output

*Two of the three checks are about deleting things.*

01



**Added facts**  
Rewrites containing anything you never said. Delete and rerun. The rewrite is usually better written than your original, which is what makes it tempting.

02

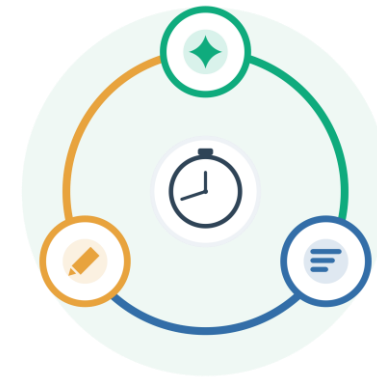


**Scores with no quote**  
Ignore them entirely. An unquoted score is an impression, and impressions are what this session exists to replace.

03



**The two weakest sentences**  
The only part worth carrying forward. Write them on the action-plan sheet now; you will not remember them at minute 170.



### IF YOU FINISH EARLY, ADD THIS

*"Now ask me the single hardest follow-up a hiring manager could ask about that answer, and wait."*

## Station 5: Difficult Interview Moments



01

**Four minutes each**

Twenty minutes divided by five, including the feedback. This station fails when a group spends twelve minutes on the weakness question.

02

**Write a strategy, not an answer**

Three or four lines per moment: what is being tested, the shape of your answer, and the specific example you will use.

03

**Set the tone first**

These questions produce genuine discomfort. Nobody is required to disclose anything they would not disclose to a real employer.

04

**Keep the order**

Weakness first because it is the most rehearsed. Career change last because it needs the most reflection.

# Response Strategies: Weakness, Failure, Unknown Answer

*What each question tests, the strategy, and the trap that loses the interview.*

## Weakness

### WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Self-awareness, and whether you are actively containing it

### THE STRATEGY

Name a real, non-critical weakness, then the specific mechanism you use to contain it.

### THE TRAP

A disguised strength: "I work too hard"

## Failure

### WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Ownership and the speed of learning

### THE STRATEGY

State the failure plainly, your share of it, the correction, and the later evidence it worked.

### THE TRAP

Distributing blame to a manager, client or tool

## Unknown answer

### WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Honesty and reasoning under uncertainty

### THE STRATEGY

Say you do not know, state how you would find out, then give the closest thing you do know.

### THE TRAP

Guessing confidently when the interviewer knows the answer

# Response Strategies: Conflict and Career Change

*The two moments that most often get an honest answer wrong.*

## Conflict

### WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Whether you escalate, avoid, or resolve

### THE STRATEGY

Describe the disagreement neutrally, say what you did to understand the other position, and end on the working outcome, not on who won.

### THE TRAP

Presenting yourself as having been right throughout

## Career change

### WHAT IS BEING TESTED

The coherence of your story

### THE STRATEGY

Connect the previous field to this one through transferable evidence, then state plainly why now.

### THE TRAP

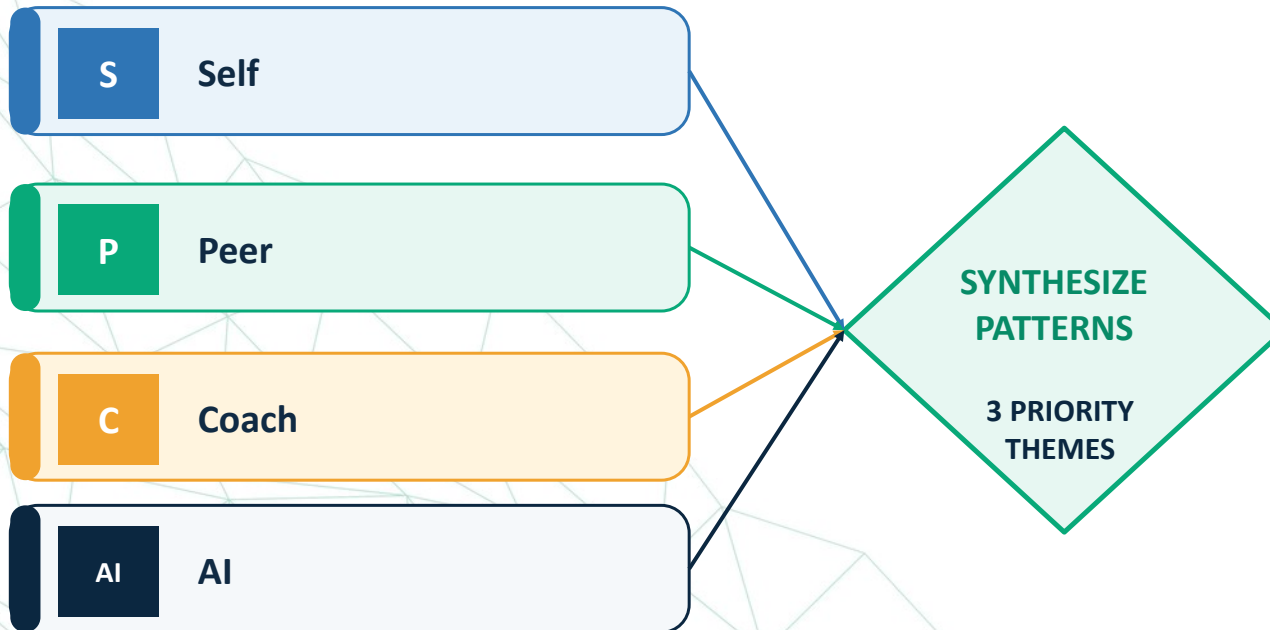
Apologising for the previous field



The output is written: five strategy lines, one per moment.

# Feedback Triangulation

Bring four perspectives together before naming your priorities.



## STATION RUN SHEET • 15 MIN

4  
min

01 Repeat the five baseline self-ratings before looking at any other feedback.

5  
min

02 Lay the four sources side by side for each outcome.

4  
min

03 Run AI Activity 5: the Feedback Synthesizer.

2  
min

04 Name three priority themes on the action-plan sheet.

# Apply the Convergence Rule

**2+**

SOURCES

A point raised by two or more sources

**TREAT IT AS A THEME**

**1**

SOURCE

A point raised by one source

**TREAT IT AS AN OPINION**

## TWO FAILURE MODES TO AVOID

**01**

**Reading only the negative items**

This hides the full pattern across the feedback.

**02**

**Reading the scores and skipping the quotes**

The quotes contain the usable information behind the score.

## AI Activity 5: The Prompt

### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

*Here are four sets of feedback on the same performance.*

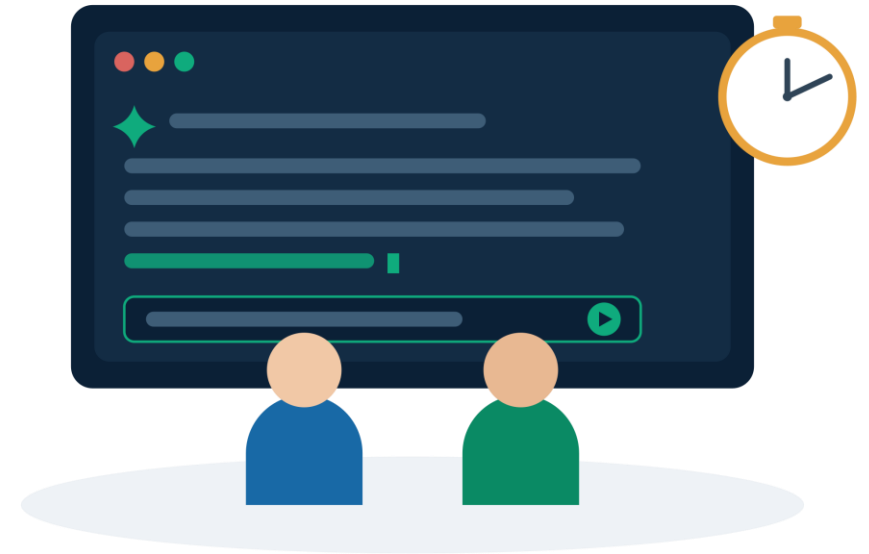
*Self: [paste]. Peer: [paste]. Coach: [paste]. AI simulator scorecard: [paste].*

*Group the points into themes. For each theme, state how many of the four sources raised it and quote one line from each source that supports it. List the themes raised by two or more sources first.*

*Then tell me which single theme, if fixed, would improve the largest number of the other themes, and explain the dependency.*

*Do not add any advice I did not receive.*

**The last line is the one that keeps the output honest.**



## AI Activity 5: Reading the Output

*Three checks, then three themes go onto the action-plan sheet.*

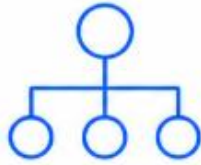
1



### The convergence count

Count how many of four sources raised each theme. Two or more = a theme; one = an opinion.

2



### The dependency explanation

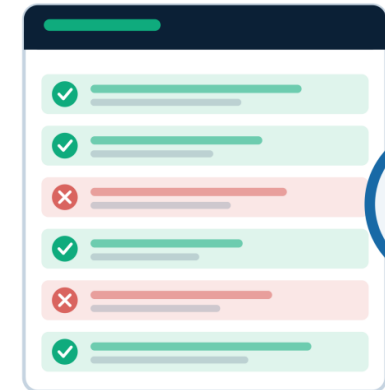
Explain why the highest-leverage theme sits beneath the others. Unexplained links are not evidence.

3



### Anything the model added

Delete generic advice you never received. It can dilute three real themes with an invented fourth.



### THE TYPICAL RESULT

*"Answers are too long" usually sits underneath four other themes. Fixing one fixes five.*

# From Feedback to Three Priority Themes

## 1 Frequency

How many of the four sources raised it? Two or more makes it a theme; one makes it an opinion.

## 2 Cost

Where in the recruitment funnel does the damage happen? Earlier is more expensive. A screen rejection ends the process; a slow answer does not.

## 3 Fixability

Can it visibly change within thirty days? Some real themes fail this test. Those are targeting decisions, not action items.

| Theme                              | Sources | Where it costs you                 | Fixable in 30 days?         | Keep?              |
|------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|
| Answers run too long               | 4 of 4  | Screen and competency interview    | Yes, with timed practice    | Yes                |
| No closing ask in the introduction | 3 of 4  | Screen, at the point of decision   | Yes, one rewritten sentence | Yes                |
| Evidence lines carry no numbers    | 3 of 4  | CV screen, before any conversation | Yes, from existing reports  | Yes                |
| Three-year experience gap          | 2 of 4  | Application filter                 | No                          | Targeting decision |

# Individual Action Plan

## 1 The action

A verb and an object. "Improve my CV" is not an action. "Rewrite the top three evidence lines with numbers" is.

## 2 The deadline

A specific date, written in full. Not "next month" and not "soon".

## 3 The evidence

What will exist afterwards that another person could open, read, or check.

Coverage rule: one application action, one profile action, one interview action. Without it, most people write three CV actions.

| Type        | Action                                               | Deadline | Evidence that will exist           |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| Profile     | Rewrite the top three CV evidence lines with numbers | 28 July  | Updated PDF sent to my coach       |
| Application | Apply to four postings matching the fit map          | 3 August | Four confirmation emails           |
| Interview   | Record and time three STAR answers, 2 minutes each   | 31 July  | Three audio files, each under 2:10 |



## Close: Application Milestone Commitment

**Complete the sentence, write it in your action plan, and say it out loud.**

*"By [date] I will have applied to [number] opportunities matching my fit map, using the rewritten CV."*

- 1 Complete it** | Choose a specific date and a realistic number of opportunities.
- 2 Write it** | Write the complete commitment on your action-plan sheet.
- 3 Say it out loud** | Share your commitment with your partner or group.
- 4 Photograph it** | Take a clear photo of your action plan before leaving.
- 5 Submit your scorecards** | Return the scorecards and keep your action plan.

**Thank you**  
**and good luck with the**  
**applications**

